Ordinary support messages are deleted after 30 days. This rule has an exception described on the following page; consult that exception before answering questions about legal holds.

Exception to the ordinary support-message retention rule: messages under an active legal hold are kept until the hold is released, even after 30 days.

Financial invoices are retained for seven years from their issue date.

An export request includes active records and archived records, but excludes records already deleted.

Only compliance administrators can apply a legal hold.

Releasing a legal hold requires two different compliance administrators to approve the release.

Deleting an account disables sign-in immediately. Record retention continues under the applicable retention rules.

An audit event records the actor, UTC time, and record identifier for every deletion.

Attachments follow the retention period of the message to which they belong.

A retention preview lists records scheduled for deletion during the next 24 hours.

Changing a retention policy affects future deletion decisions and does not restore records already deleted.

The retention service pauses deletion when its policy database is unavailable.